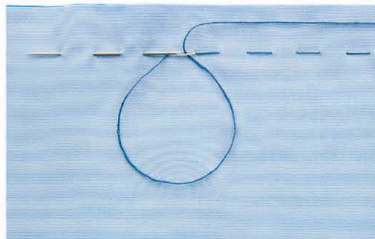


▶ HAND STITCHES FOR QUILTMaking

Although most quilts today are made on a machine, there are a number of techniques that require hand

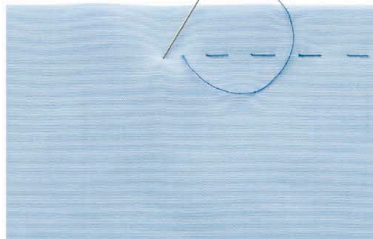
sewing; it is important to choose the correct stitch for the best result.

RUNNING STITCH



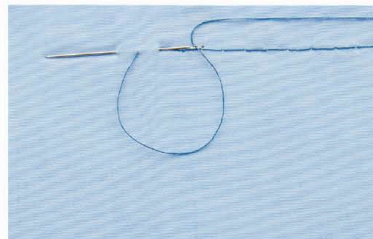
This is the most common stitch for hand piecing. Take the needle in and out of the fabric several times, making small, evenly spaced stitches. Pull the needle through gently until the thread is taut, but not tense. Repeat to the end of the seam.

STAB STITCH



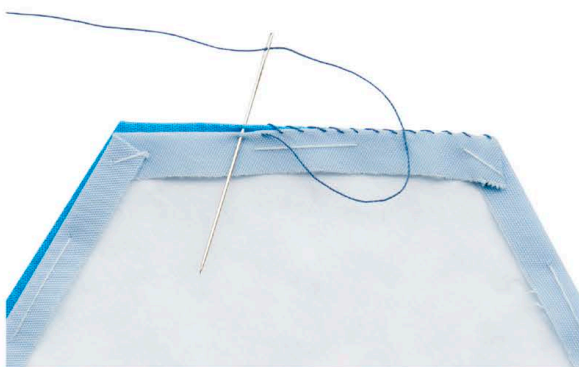
This popular quilter's stitch is useful for sewing through several layers or into thick fabric. Take the needle vertically through the fabric layers from the top and pull until the thread is taut but not tense. For the next stitch, bring the needle through vertically from below. Continue sewing to the end of the seam.

BACKSTITCH



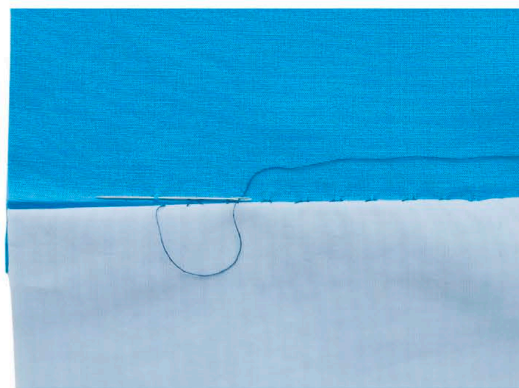
Backstitch can be worked in a row as an alternative to running stitch to join units together. Bring the needle through all the layers to the right side, then insert it a short distance behind the point where it emerged. Bring it back up to the right side again, the same distance in front of the point where it first emerged. Repeat to the end of the seam.

OVERSEWING



Also known as whipstitch or overcasting, oversewing is used to join two edges with an almost invisible seam. Bring the needle through the back edge to the front edge, picking up a few threads from each edge as you go. Pull gently on the thread until it is taut but not tense, and repeat.

SLIP STITCH



Used mainly in appliqué, slip stitch joins two pieces of fabric with an invisible line of stitching. Knot the thread and bring the needle to the front, hiding the knot in the folded edge of the top piece. Now pick up a thread or two on the back piece, then take the needle into the top piece right next to this stitch and slide it a short distance inside the fold. Bring the needle to the front again, then repeat, catching a few threads on the back piece with each stitch.